THE EMERSON EMPIRE SERVICES AND PRICING GUIDE

Customer Guide for Intake, Resource Navigation, Business Direction, and Community Partnerships

Customer-Facing Guide

Prepared for Lyric Helena Emerson | May 2026

Welcome

The Emerson Empire is the umbrella brand and operational home for the broader mission. It connects individuals, families, students, entrepreneurs, small businesses, and community partners with the appropriate Emerson division or referral pathway.

Our Approach

We believe people deserve clear information, respectful support, and practical next steps. This guide explains available services, general pricing, free options, and possible referral pathways for clients who may qualify for outside support.

Services and Pricing

Service	Best For	What May Be Included	General Price	Free / Reduced-Cost Options
General Consultation & Intake	Individuals, families, students, founders, agency referrals	15-min discovery call; 30-min intake; 60-min planning	Free; $25; $50	Free for basic direction, students, low-income clients, and agency referrals when capacity allows
Community Resource Navigation	Low-income individuals, families, students, unemployed clients, community referrals	Basic guidance; personalized plan; expanded support session	Free; $25-$50; $75	Free basic guidance; fee waived for hardship/referral cases when possible
Business Direction & Brand Intake	Entrepreneurs, small businesses, independent professionals	30-min direction call; 60-min consult; 90-min strategy session	$35; $75; $125	Sliding scale for student entrepreneurs, first-time founders, and community organizations
Community Workshops & Group Education	Libraries, nonprofits, schools, workforce groups, public audiences	Public workshop; low-cost workshop; private workshop	Free; $10-$25/person; $150-$500	Free/reduced by partner agreement or sponsorship

Service	Best For	What May Be Included	General Price	Free / Reduced-Cost Options
Partnership & Referral Coordination	Schools, libraries, nonprofits, workforce partners, local agencies	Initial partner call; workshop/program collaboration	Free; custom	Reduced/waived for mission-aligned community partners

Best-Fit Client Pathways

The Emerson Empire is the best starting point when a client is unsure whether they need financial education, business support, career readiness help, an internship pathway, or a community referral.

- General guidance and intake
- Resource navigation and referral support
- Business direction and brand/service clarity
- Community workshops and partnership conversations

Free, Reduced-Cost, and Low-Income Waiver Policy

The Emerson businesses are designed to balance sustainability with access. Fees support staff time, document preparation, systems, training, and program growth. At the same time, basic guidance, referrals, discovery calls, public workshops, and internship participation should remain accessible whenever possible.

- Students and active interns
- Low-income individuals and families
- Unemployed job seekers
- Single parents and caregivers
- Seniors and veterans
- First-generation college students and adult learners
- Clients referred by community agencies, libraries, schools, workforce programs, or nonprofit partners
- Small community organizations and early-stage founders with limited resources

Low-Income Waiver Language

Clients experiencing financial hardship may request a reduced fee, sliding-scale rate, or fee waiver. Waivers are reviewed based on need, service availability, licensing requirements, and program capacity. When a direct service is not the best fit, staff should connect the individual with local agencies, nonprofit organizations, workforce programs, libraries, public resources, or community partners whenever possible.

How to Request Help

Clients may ask about a sliding-scale rate or waiver during intake. We may request basic information about need, service goals, and document readiness, but we aim to keep the process respectful and simple.

State, Federal, and Public Funding / Referral Options

These options should be presented as referral pathways or possible third-party supports, not as guaranteed funding for Emerson services. Eligibility, covered services, provider approval, documentation, and available funds are determined by each public agency or partner program.

Program / Pathway	Best Fit	Potential Eligibility / Coverage	Emerson Use
IRS VITA/TCE	Tax preparation and tax education referral pathway	VITA generally supports people making $69,000 or less, people with disabilities, and limited-English-speaking taxpayers; TCE focuses on taxpayers age 60+.	Use as a referral option before charging low-income clients for basic returns. The Emerson Agency may later explore becoming a VITA/TCE partner if capacity allows.
IRS Free File	Free federal guided filing software	2026 IRS Free File is available for taxpayers with 2025 AGI of $89,000 or less; Free File Fillable Forms are available regardless of income for people comfortable preparing their own return.	Use for clients who can self-file with guidance and do not need paid tax preparation.
WIOA / SC Works	Career readiness, job search support, training assistance	Eligibility and services are determined by local workforce development areas; WIOA includes Adult, Dislocated Worker, and Youth funding streams.	EPDG can refer clients to SC Works and later explore Eligible Training Provider List readiness before presenting any program as WIOA-fundable.
SNAP Employment & Training	Employment, training, work experience, and supports for SNAP participants	SNAP E&T helps eligible SNAP participants gain skills, training, work experience, and support services such as case management or transportation depending on state/local availability.	Refer clients receiving SNAP to their state SNAP E&T program for possible no-cost training support.
Vocational Rehabilitation	Employment and training support for eligible people with disabilities	South Carolina VR provides job training, readiness, placement, and individualized employment services for eligible South Carolinians with disabilities.	Refer clients who disclose a disability-related employment barrier; do not collect medical details beyond what is needed for referral.
Pell Grants / Federal Student Aid	Eligible college or approved education programs	For 2026-27, the maximum Pell Grant scheduled award is $7,395, subject to FAFSA and school/program eligibility.	Use only as a referral for accredited/eligible education programs, not as a promise that EPDG services are Pell-funded.
SBA / SBDC / SCORE-style support	Small business counseling, training, lender navigation, business planning	The SBA supports small businesses through counseling, training, lenders, contracting resources, and local assistance partners.	Use as a referral option for clients needing financing, formal business counseling, or procurement support beyond Emerson scope.

Important Disclaimers

- Prices are planning estimates and may change based on service complexity, document readiness, client goals, licensing requirements, and program capacity.
- Insurance services are subject to licensing, carrier availability, underwriting approval, state requirements, and product suitability standards.

- Tax preparation services depend on document review, eligibility, federal/state requirements, and service capacity. Educational tax guidance does not replace legal or accounting advice when specialized professional advice is required.
- Financial education services are informational and do not guarantee credit-score changes, debt removal, insurance approval, tax outcomes, business revenue, employment, or income.
- Career coaching, professional development, internship participation, or workforce training does not guarantee employment, academic credit, promotion, income, or admission to any school or program.
- Public funding options are referrals only unless a formal provider approval, contract, or partnership is established.

Next Step

Start with a discovery call or intake message. If we are not the right provider, we will do our best to point you toward a better-fit resource, public program, local agency, or community partner.